
KLAY & KESAR

Pre-Launch Social Media Strategy

3-Week Campaign | 8 - 28 September 2026 | Website Launch: 28 Sep



THE BRIEF

Klay & Kesar has completed brand development, formulation, packaging, and positioning, but has never posted. Social media is the only public-facing brand touchpoint for the three weeks leading into launch. This plan carries the full weight of the first impression.

"Make people feel the brand first, understand it second, and discover the products third."

CAMPAIGN WINDOW

8 Sep - 28 Sep 2026 (3 weeks)

WEBSITE GO-LIVE

28 September 2026

PRIMARY PLATFORM

Instagram

SECONDARY

TikTok (repurposed Reels)

CAMPAIGN TYPE

Organic brand-building

CONTENT VOLUME

15 feed posts + daily Stories

BRAND DNA

The story every post comes back to.

KLAY

Earth . Grounding . Purity . Strength

The Mother

She brought the earth. Ancient ingredient wisdom, globally rooted heritage, the foundation of ritual.

KESAR

Saffron . Radiance . Warmth . Transformation

The Daughter

Her daughter brought the gold. Modern clean formulation, scientific precision, the ritual made clinical.

TOGETHER

You cannot glow until you are grounded. You cannot rise until you are rooted.

POSITIONING

Ancient ingredient wisdom + modern clean formulation

PHILOSOPHY

Ritual, not routine. Honouring skin, not fixing it.

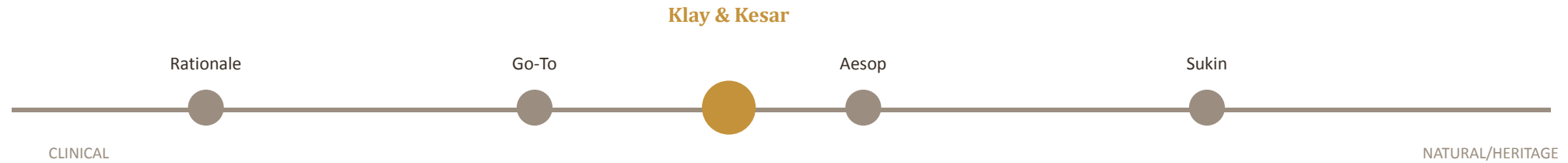
BRAND PERSONA

The Warrior Woman: leads with softness, fights with purpose

"Ancient wisdom. Modern precision. One ritual."

POSITIONING

Where Klay & Kesar sits, and why it matters.



WHAT WE ARE

- + Heritage-rooted, globally framed
- + Ritual-led, not product-led
- + Identity-led femininity, not insecurity marketing
- + Earned luxury (felt, not declared)
- + PR and editorial-ready from day one

WHAT WE ARE NOT

- Not an Ayurvedic brand (hard boundary)
- Not fear-based ("fix your skin" language)
- Not generic natural skincare
- Not influencer-led or trend-chasing
- Not vanity-metric optimised

TARGET AUDIENCE

PRIMARY

The Warrior Woman

AGE	25 - 45
PROFILE	Educated, intentional, values substance over noise
BEHAVIOUR	Reads ingredient lists, researches before buying, ritualistic
EXPECTATION	Efficacy + experience without compromising integrity or ethics
CURRENTLY SHOPS	Aesop, Go-To, Rationale
RESPONDS TO	Intelligence, empowerment, identity, recognition
DOES NOT RESPOND TO	Fear-based marketing, insecurity framing, trend-chasing

SECONDARY

The Conscious Gifter

Drawn by founder story, packaging, and gifting experience. Values meaning behind the product.

GEOGRAPHIC FOCUS

Brisbane
Sydney
Melbourne
Gold Coast
Perth
Adelaide

PLATFORMS: Instagram (primary) + TikTok (secondary, repurposed Reels) | Pinterest & YouTube (future)

THE STRATEGIC PROBLEM

Why a generic pre-launch teaser sequence won't work for this brand.

Structure alone is not a campaign. Golden-hour light, clay textures, and saffron macros are shared category language. Every quiet-luxury beauty brand uses some version of this palette. Structure tells you what to post each week. It does not give the audience a reason to remember Klay & Kesar specifically, or a thread to follow that makes them come back.

The test:

"Could any skincare brand have posted this?" If yes, it fails.

WHAT NO COMPETITOR OWNS

Five products named after warrior virtues (not ingredients, not benefits)

A mother-daughter founding story that IS the product (Klay = earth = mother, Kesar = saffron = daughter)

"You are not made of glass. You are forged of clay and saffron" as an approved hero line

An affirmation built into each SKU

A brand persona (Warrior Woman) that directly maps to the product architecture

Global ingredient provenance without cultural ownership

Two Big Ideas were developed to activate these assets. Both are presented for review.

"Not Made of Glass"

From the brand's hero line: "You are not made of glass. You are forged of clay and saffron."

The campaign is about who SHE is. It makes the woman the subject, not the product. "Not Made of Glass" is a statement every warrior woman wants to claim about herself. It reframes skincare from protection (glass is fragile, handle with care) to recognition (you are already strong, this ritual honours that).

WEEK 1

The Elements

"What is she made of?"

Raw earth, water, light, warmth, bloom. Five materials, unexplained. The audience feels before they understand.

WEEK 2

The Warrior

"Not glass. Something the earth already knew."

Warrior Woman manifesto. Five virtues named as character. Ingredients as the warrior's armoury. Science as proof. She sees herself.

WEEK 3

The Ritual

"Claim what you're made of."

Five virtues become five products. Each SKU is literally what she is made of. Full range. Countdown. Launch.

HERO LINES: "Not made of glass." | "What are you made of?" | "She is made of calm. Of confidence. Of grace. Of strength. Of comfort." | "Five virtues. One ritual. Yours."

"Virtue Over Vanity"

From the product architecture: five products named after virtues, in an industry built on vanity.

The campaign makes the brand a challenger. It draws a philosophical line between K&K and every other brand in the category. Vanity says "fix yourself." Virtue says "honour yourself." No other brand can stand on the virtue side of that line, because none of them named their products after character traits.

WEEK 1

Beyond the Surface

"Something deeper than what you've been sold."

Elemental depth, texture, ritual atmosphere. The audience senses a brand that operates on a different plane. No product, no explanation.

WEEK 2

The Five Virtues

"Five virtues. Zero vanity."

Warrior Woman manifesto. Five virtues named as philosophy. Ingredients as heritage, not hype. Science as proof. The alternative she has been waiting for.

WEEK 3

Claim Your Virtue

"Claim your virtue."

Five virtues become five products. Each SKU is a virtue made tangible. Full range. Countdown. Launch. Vanity lost. Virtue won.

HERO LINES: "Virtue over vanity." | "She chose virtue." | "Your skin doesn't need fixing. It needs honouring." | "Calm. Confidence. Grace. Strength. Comfort. Not claims. Virtues."

THE DECISION

Both ideas pass the distinctiveness test. They pull in different strategic directions.

OPTION A

"Not Made of Glass"

SUBJECT	The woman. Her identity.
STRATEGY	Identity-first. She claims who she is.
tone	Empowering, intimate, revelatory
W2 ANCHOR	"What are you made of?"
STRENGTH	Creates a tribe. Deeply personal. High save/share.
ENGAGEMENT	"What are you made of?" (open, identity-driven)
RISK	Softer commercial intent; harder to pivot to product
BEST IF	The founders want emotional depth first, commerce second

OPTION B

"Virtue Over Vanity"

SUBJECT	The brand. Its philosophy against the category.
STRATEGY	Category-challenger. K&K draws a line in the sand.
tone	Contrarian, intelligent, philosophical
W2 ANCHOR	"Five virtues. Zero vanity."
STRENGTH	Sharp positioning. Clear enemy. PR-ready framing.
ENGAGEMENT	"Virtue or vanity?" (binary, high polarisation)
RISK	"Vanity" could feel judgemental if not handled deftly
BEST IF	The founders want category disruption, editorial edge

HAV STRATEGY RECOMMENDATION: Both ideas are strong. Option A is safer for a brand that has never posted. Option B is bolder for a brand that wants to arrive with a point of view. We are ready to execute either.

THE FIVE VIRTUES

Every product is named for a virtue of the warrior. Every formula is a tribute.

SOLACE

Calm & Resilience

Rice Water Sandalwood Cream Cleanser

"When I choose resilience, everything aligns."

Rice crop stem / Water, stillness

ORTU SOLE

Confidence & Radiance

Kakadu Plum Vitamin C Serum

"The more I trust myself, the brighter I become."

Kakadu plum / Dawn light, gold

ELYSIA

Grace & Renewal

Blue Lotus Rebalancing Moisturiser

"My renewal is my rebellion; grace is how I win."

Lotus flower / Bloom, balance

TERRA

Strength & Balance

Chandan, Multani Mitti & Saffron Mask

"I draw strength from the ground beneath me."

Saffron flower / Earth, clay, stone

CARESS

Comfort & Nurture

Vanilla & Coffee Lip Balm

"I am gentle. I am not fragile."

Coffee bean / Warmth, softness

CAMPAIGN ARCHITECTURE

Three weeks. Three acts. One warrior. (Shared structure; hero lines adapt per chosen Big Idea.)

WEEK 1 | 8 - 14 SEP

FEEL

Atmosphere + Mystery

OBJECTIVE

Curiosity. "What is this?"

EMOTIONAL REGISTER

Mystery, power, elemental beauty

ON SCREEN

Raw elements: earth, water, light, warmth, bloom. No product. No explanation. The brand speaks through material before meaning. Five textures seed the virtue reveal.

WEEK 2 | 15 - 21 SEP

UNDERSTAND

Identity + Credibility

OBJECTIVE

Meaning. "Who is she, and why?"

EMOTIONAL REGISTER

Strength, recognition, intimacy

ON SCREEN

Warrior Woman manifesto. Five virtues named (as character, not products). Ingredient heritage as the warrior's armoury. Science as proof. Audience sees herself.

WEEK 3 | 22 - 28 SEP

WANT

Desire + Conversion

OBJECTIVE

Action. "I need to be there."

EMOTIONAL REGISTER

Anticipation building to arrival

ON SCREEN

Five virtues become five products. Each SKU is a virtue made tangible. Packaging, range reveal, countdown. The only week with explicit waitlist/website CTAs.

WEEK 1: FEEL THE BRAND

8 - 14 September | Five raw elements. No explanation.

POST	FORMAT	PILLAR	CONCEPT DIRECTION	CTA
P1	Reel	Brand World	Opening film: earth, water, light, warmth, bloom. Five elements, unexplained. Brand name resolves at end. No voice, no text.	Save this
P2	Static	Brand World	Saffron threads on raw limestone. Editorial macro. Copy: "Some rituals are older than memory." No product.	Follow
P3	Reel	Ritual	Five ritual gestures: pressing, pouring, smoothing, grounding, softening. Cinematic, slow, looping. No words.	Save this
P4	Carousel	Brand World	Palette carousel: five slides, each one elemental texture (clay, gold light, lotus water, stone, silk). Pure atmosphere.	Follow
P5	Reel	Ritual	Clay dissolving in water, light breaking through. Ends on: "You are not made of glass." First line of copy.	Learn more

SUCCESS: Saves, DMs asking "what is this?", profile visits. No one should know what the products are yet.

Phase-Wise Content Bucket

Three phases. One Content Bucket.

WEEK 1 | 8 - 14 SEP

FEEL

"Something is coming soon"

Creative Pin Board - <https://pin.it/7ERC4lkkA>

Reel/Video References -

1. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DYzSQSrJ8g9/?stkn=MjRiMThxY2lObDU=>
2. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DXpyPZJjW1j/?stkn=bDk2aGo3MWJmcGFu>
3. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DUS6xPtDZMw/?stkn=MWFpbHV5YTRuc3BpZW==> | Concept Note - Story Behind The Key Ingredients

WEEK 2: UNDERSTAND THE BRAND

15 - 21 September | The Warrior Woman revealed. Five virtues named.

POST	FORMAT	PILLAR	CONCEPT DIRECTION	CTA
P6	Reel	Warrior Woman	Manifesto film: "For the woman who leads with softness, and fights with purpose." Voiceover + elemental visuals. This is WHO she is.	Follow
P7	Carousel	Five Virtues	Five slides, five affirmations. Calm & Resilience, Confidence & Radiance, Grace & Renewal, Strength & Balance, Comfort & Nurture. No product names. Pure philosophy.	Save this
P8	Reel	Ingredient	"The warrior's armoury": saffron (3,500 yrs), blue lotus (ancient Egypt), Kakadu plum (65,000 yrs First Nations), rice water (Japan). Globally sourced, science-backed.	Save this
P9	Static	Science	"Ancient wisdom. Modern precision." Standardised crocin, clean formulation, clinical testing. Credibility without clinical coldness.	Discover
P10	Reel	Texture	First texture fragment: macro of product surface, no packaging, no name. Copy: "One of five." Bridge into Week 3.	Save this

KEY ACTIVATION: Stories virtue quiz using the five affirmations. Identity-driven, high share/save signal. Adapts per Big Idea chosen.

Phase-Wise Content Bucket

Three phases. One Content Bucket.

WEEK 2 | 15 - 21 SEP

UNDERSTAND

"Meet the warrior women."

Creative Pin Board - <https://pin.it/Wf0y64d41>

Reel/Video References -

1. <https://www.instagram.com/reels/DZGJsP1OP-1/> | Concept Note - K&K's Idea of beauty (reveal the warrior women)
2. <https://in.pinterest.com/pin/1141803311807433450/> - Concept note - Rituals of a warrior women
3. <https://www.instagram.com/reels/DOgE-weD7de/>
4. https://www.instagram.com/reel/DcPGc8YSW_0/?stkn=MWxhdW01b2cweTJpcQ==

WEEK 3: WANT THE BRAND

22 - 28 September | Five virtues become five products.

POST	FORMAT	PILLAR	CONCEPT DIRECTION	CTA
P11	Carousel	Five Virtues	The range reveal tease: each virtue IS a product. Solace, Ortu Sole, Elysia, Terra, Caress. Virtue + product name + hero ingredient + motif.	Discover
P12	Reel	Product	First packaging silhouette, macro. Real product photography. "A virtue you can hold." Slow, restrained, editorial.	Join waitlist
P13	Carousel	Product	Full range tease: five products, five virtues, five motifs, unified. Hero packaging, clean layout. The complete collection.	Visit website
P14	Reel	Countdown	Countdown film: days-to-launch, cinematic montage of all five elements + products. Anticipation.	Join waitlist
P15	Reel	Countdown	Launch-day film: "You are not made of glass. You are forged of clay and saffron. Your ritual begins now."	Shop now

REVEAL SEQUENCE: Brand > Warrior Woman > Five Virtues > Ingredients > Science > Products > Full Range > Launch

Phase-Wise Content Bucket

Three phases. One Content Bucket.

WEEK 3 | 22 - 28 SEP

WANT

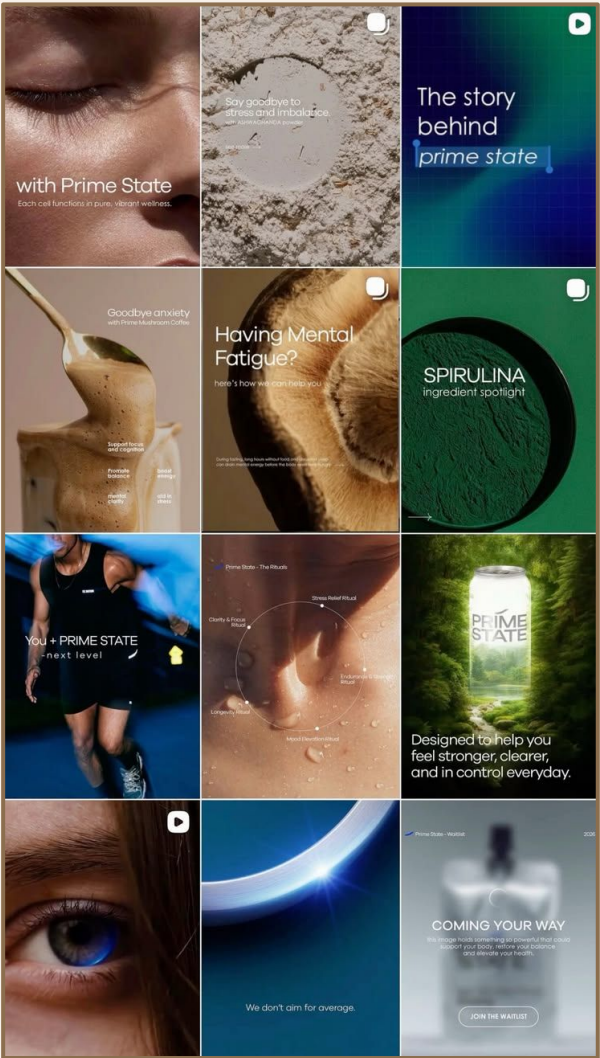
"Now, it's yours."

Creative Pin Board - <https://pin.it/4PS9on97g>

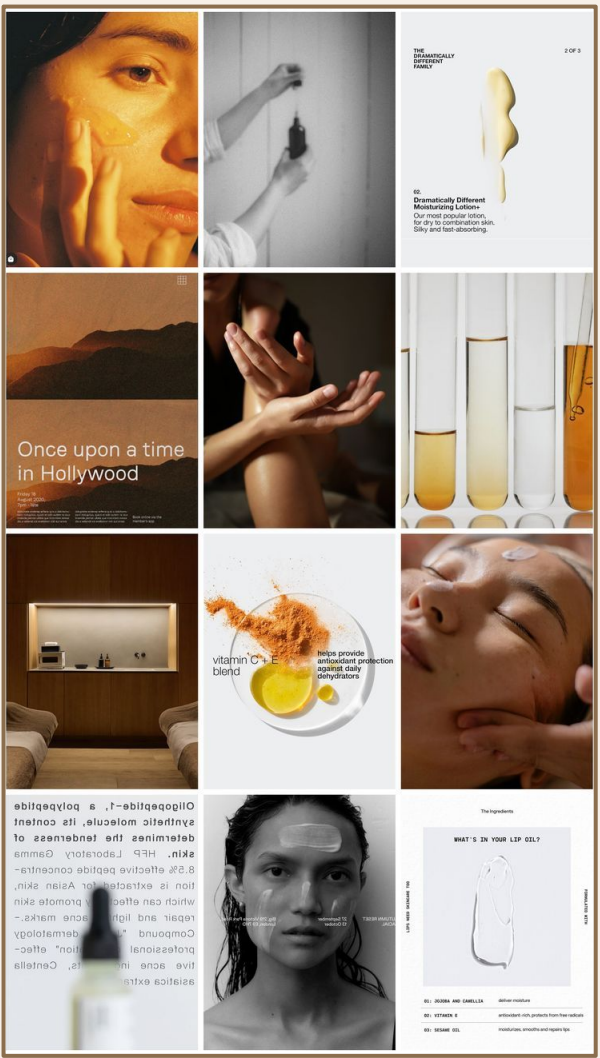
Reel/Video References -

1. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DbPL1oMzJK8/?stkn=MXAyc2R5Mzh2MnVqZQ==>
2. <https://in.pinterest.com/pin/19844054603986250/>
3. <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DaLR93WsWSW/?stkn=MW1kMGZ3bHJiczRzZw==> | From the founder_Podcast/Netflix Intro format
4. https://www.instagram.com/reel/DR2_8wUicWU/?stkn=MTV5d3l3OXo3MXh2YQ==
5. <https://in.pinterest.com/pin/8022105582975416/>
6. <https://in.pinterest.com/pin/1127518456792516225/>
7. <https://in.pinterest.com/pin/908530924822428512/>
8. <https://in.pinterest.com/pin/1085719422721807352/>

Pre Launch Grid Layout Ideas



OR



CONTENT PILLARS

Ten pillars, rotated so the grid never reads as a product catalogue.

01

Brand World / Mood

Raw elements, golden-hour light, elemental atmosphere

W1

02

Ritual

The philosophy of ritual over routine

ALL

03

Warrior Woman

The brand persona: her virtues, her standards

W1-2

04

Five Virtues

Calm, Confidence, Grace, Strength, Comfort as philosophy

W2-3

05

Ingredient Heritage

Global provenance: the warrior's armoury

W2

06

Modern Science

Clean formulation, standardised actives, clinical proof

W2

07

Product Texture

Macro fragments, no full product ID until W3

W2-3

08

Founder Story

Two women, two worlds: earth and gold

W2

09

Product Reveal

Five SKUs: each virtue made tangible

W3

10

Countdown

Direct countdown to 28 Sep

W3

CONTENT MIX & CADENCE

15

FEED POSTS

across 3 weeks

9

REELS

6-15 sec, cinematic

6

STATIC/CAROUSEL

editorial, macro

21

STORY DAYS

4-7 frames daily

REEL SPECIFICATIONS

9:16 aspect ratio

6-15 seconds (aesthetic/teaser content)

Hook within 1-2 seconds

Minimal on-screen text

Slow cinematic movement, macro detail

Designed to loop where appropriate

Copy within Instagram safe zones

STORIES STRATEGY

Stories are a separate strategy, not a feed mirror.

BTS, ingredient close-ups, polls

"Guess what's coming" element teasers

Founder snippets + packaging glimpses

Texture videos + countdown

Recurring engagement (adapts per Big Idea):

A: "What are you made of?" | B: "Virtue or vanity?"

VISUAL DIRECTION

Within 3 seconds: Earth. Gold. Woman. Heritage. Science. Ritual.

IN

- + Australian golden-hour light
- + Ivory / cream / pearl / macadamia palette
- + Natural limestone, saffron red (sparingly)
- + Brushed gold accents
- + Sheer ivory fabric, water, natural reflections
- + Clay texture, glass, natural shadow
- + Macro ingredient photography
- + Natural skin, generous negative space
- + Slow, deliberate movement
- + Editorial composition
- + Elemental textures per virtue (signature visual system)

OUT

- Ayurvedic/Indian-spa cues (marigolds, mandalas)
- Bright orange/yellow grading
- Excessive gold or generic spa photography
- Products buried in ingredient piles
- Green-leaf flat lays
- Clinical/lab-blue aesthetic
- Glitter, busy compositions
- Canva-look graphics, TikTok-style fonts
- AI-looking skin/liquid/ingredients
- Different aesthetic post-to-post

CREATIVE DIRECTION

SIGNATURE MOTIF: FIVE ELEMENTS

Each virtue maps to a visual element. The grid reads as one forge.

SOLACE	Water, rice-stem calm, cool stillness
ORTU SOLE	Dawn light, Kakadu warmth, rising gold
ELYSIA	Lotus bloom, balance, soft radiance
TERRA	Raw earth, clay, saffron flower, stone
CARESS	Coffee warmth, vanilla silk, gentle touch

HERO LINES (SHARED)

"You are not made of glass. You are forged of clay and saffron."

"For the woman who leads with softness, and fights with purpose."

"Some rituals are older than memory."

"Earth-born. Science-backed. Universally yours."

"Calm. Confidence. Grace. Strength. Comfort."

THE DISTINCTIVENESS TEST

Could Aesop, Rationale, or Sukin post this campaign under their own logo?

They could post golden-hour light and clay textures. They could NOT name five products after warrior virtues, use "forged of clay and saffron" as their founding line, or run a virtue-identity quiz rooted in their product architecture. That is what separates a mood board from a campaign.

AI/HIGGSFIELD: Permitted for elemental textures, abstract brand films, ingredient macros. Real product photography required the moment actual product appears on screen.

TONE OF VOICE

Refined, poetic, powerful. Like a queen giving a battle cry with grace.

THE VOICE

Refined	but never pretentious
Intelligent	but never arrogant
Poetic	but never vague
Warm	but never casual
Confident	but never loud
Feminine	but never girlish

NEVER SAY

"Fix your skin" / "fight ageing" / "problem skin"
"Flawless skin" / "chemical-free"
"Ancient Indian secret" / "Ayurvedic skincare"
Unsubstantiated "clinically proven" claims
"OMG something exciting is coming!!"
Excessive emojis / influencer language
The word "luxury" stated outright

VOICE DIAL (from the Brand Bible)

1 : POETIC	Baskerville Italic energy. Hero copy, taglines.	<i>"You are not made of glass."</i>
2 : WARM AUTHORITY	Informed, confident, gentle. Product copy, editorial.	<i>"Rice water has brightened skin for centuries."</i>
3 : DIRECT CLARITY	Clean, factual. Ingredients, claims, FAQs.	<i>"Saffron standardised for active crocin."</i>
4 : NEVER	Clinical, aggressive, apologetic, trend-chasing.	<i>"Anti-ageing formula that fights damage fast."</i>

CLAIMS DISCIPLINE

No invented scientific claims. No overstated ingredient benefits. No unverified historical claims. Anything questionable flagged for approval before publishing.

CONTENT FRAMEWORKS

Optimised for CTR and CVR across the funnel.

HOOK FRAMEWORK (REELS)

CTR DRIVER

First 1-2 sec: elemental disruption (texture, light shift, silhouette)

No text overlay in hook; let the visual arrest the scroll

Pattern interrupt: slow in a fast feed (cinematic pace)

Audio: ambient/natural sound, never trending audio

Loop design: end frame echoes opening frame

SAVE-OPTIMISED CONTENT

ALGORITHM SIGNAL

Virtue-affirmation carousels (reference-worthy, identity-affirming)

Ingredient heritage as warrior's armoury (globally specific, rich)

Texture/ritual Reels (aesthetic bookmarking)

"Saves" signal depth of interest to Instagram algorithm

Target: save rate > 3% on carousel content

IDENTITY ENGAGEMENT (W2)

SHARE DRIVER

Virtue quiz using the five affirmations (identity-type prompt)

Identity-driven content gets 3-5x more shares than product content

Each virtue maps to a recognisable self-image (saves + shares)

Option A: "What are you made of?" / Option B: "Virtue or vanity?"

Target: share rate > 2% on virtue content

CONVERSION LADDER (W3)

CVR DRIVER

Virtue-to-product reveal: "a virtue you can hold"

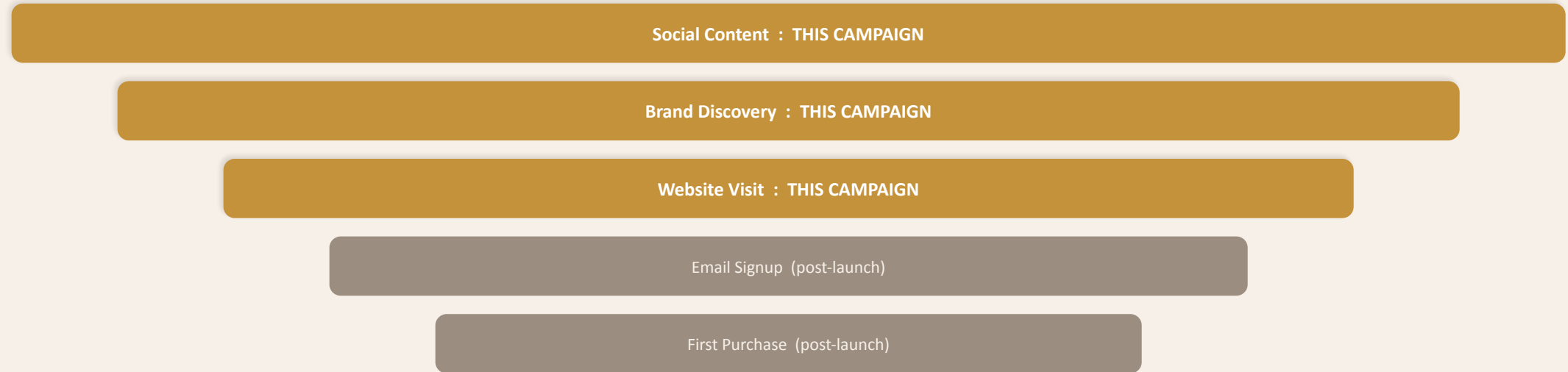
Scarcity through narrative, not artificial limitation

CTA progression: Discover > Join waitlist > Visit > Shop

Bio link: active from W3 start, not before

Email: waitlist framed as claiming your ritual/virtue

THE FUNNEL & METRICS



PRIMARY METRICS (PRE-LAUNCH)

Quality follower growth (not raw count)

Engagement rate, saves, and shares

Profile visits and website-link taps

Story completion + reply rate

Virtue quiz completion + DM replies

BRIDGE METRICS (INTO LAUNCH)

Email sign-ups generated pre-launch

"Warm audience" size at go-live
(followers + engaged profile visitors)

POST-LAUNCH (from 28 Sep):

Website traffic from social, conversion rate, revenue from social, ROAS

RISKS & GUARDRAILS

AYURVEDIC MISLABELLING

HIGH

Any ingredient-heritage content touching saffron or Multani mitti needs explicit cultural-framing check before publishing. Use "Ayurvedic-inspired ingredients," never "Ayurvedic brand."

FOUNDER PRIVACY

MEDIUM

Founder story content stays warm and personal without disclosing private family details. Daughter's identity protected per founders' preference.

CLAIMS SUBSTANTIATION

MEDIUM

Any ingredient-benefit or science-adjacent copy routes through claims review before caption is finalised. "Science-backed," not "clinically proven" (unless proven).

GRID CONSISTENCY

LOW

15 posts span 3 emotional registers. Colour grading needs a shared style reference before Week 1. Five elemental textures are the structural fix for cohesion.

APPROVAL WORKFLOW

1

SUBMISSION

Full weekly content plan submitted before each campaign week begins.

2

WHAT'S INCLUDED

Grid preview, Story plan, Reel storyboards, AI prompts, final captions, hashtags, paid recommendation.

3

FOUNDER REVIEW

2-3 business days standard turnaround. 24-hour turnaround available for urgent items.

4

REVISIONS

One revision round built into standard timeline.

5

FINAL SIGN-OFF

Written approval required before anything publishes.

THE STANDING TEST

"Does this look and sound like Klay & Kesar, or could any skincare brand have posted it?" If another brand could swap in their logo, it goes back.

NEXT STEPS

01

Choose Big Idea direction

Option A ("Not Made of Glass") or Option B ("Virtue Over Vanity"). Hero lines and engagement hooks adapt accordingly.

02

Confirm the full POA

Including campaign architecture, weekly structure, and content pillars, against your internal timeline and brand instincts.

03

Week 1 content plan delivery

Hav Strategy delivers within 24-48 hours of Big Idea confirmation, given the compressed runway to the 8 Sep start.

04

Confirm access & assets

Raw product photography, packaging assets, brand guideline files, and founder availability for Week 2 content.

05

Confirm account access + waitlist

Instagram (and TikTok) account access for scheduling. Bio link and waitlist mechanism live by start of Week 3.

KLAY & KESAR

*"You are not made of glass.
You are forged of clay and saffron."*

Prepared with care by Hav Strategy

Confidential